

Managing People

Science

May, 2026

Short Title: Managing People
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author ESHANLEY
Credits 5

Level: Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

The purpose of this module is to develop students' understanding of current people management theory and human resources practice, with specific reference to the agricultural and forestry industries, and from private and public sector perspectives. The module focuses on the central role of the line manager in the management of people in both small and larger organisations. Emphasis is placed on the contribution that effective people management and human resource strategies and practices may make to individual, team and organisational performance.

Programmes

PEOP-0001	BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Agriculture) (WD_SBSAG_B)	1 / 2 / E
PEOP-0001	BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Forestry) (WD_SBSFO_B)	1 / 2 / M

Indicative Content

- Overview of people management and HR strategies and practices in relation to organisational strategy and performance; the role of the line manager
- The employment relationship; motivation theories; the design of work; the psychological contract; employee engagement and the role of the line manager
- Organisational strategy and HR planning; the Flexible Firm model; external labour markets; internal labour markets - employee demographics; turnover; retention; stability and absenteeism measurement; demand forecasting
- Job and competency analysis; job descriptions, person specifications and competency frameworks
- The recruitment process; the legal issues relating to recruitment; employer branding; internal and external recruitment sources, effectiveness and cost
- The selection process; the legal issues relating to selection; shortlisting; selection methods, effectiveness and cost
- Offers of employment; contracts of service and contracts for service; the Terms of Employment (Information) Act
- Employment law
- Developing employees; induction training and on-boarding; training methods; training records and associated legal issues; management and leadership development
- Reward management
- Managing performance; the performance appraisal/review cycle; on-going performance management
- Managing under-performance and the associated legal issues
- Managing individual and collective employment relations

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Evaluate the strategic role of people management theory and human resource practices in the context of the agricultural and forestry industries and in small and larger organisations.
2. Assess the significance of employee motivation; the design of work; the psychological contract, and employee engagement and the contribution of the line manager to these.
3. Determine the role of the line manager in the context of the key facets of the human resource practice including HR planning; recruitment and selection; employee training and development, and performance and reward management.
4. Distinguish between the key features of Irish employment law.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Discussion groups.
- Journal articles.
- Case studies.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	70%	1,2,3,4
Continuous Assessment	30%	
Case Studies	30%	3

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Will be able to show a good knowledge of the key learning outcomes and the main theories, concepts and methods within human resource management.

50%-59%: As well as the above the student will be able to demonstrate a good understanding of the key learning outcomes as well as be able to describe and evaluate the effectiveness of various HRM practices.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of all the topics and be able to demonstrate best professional standards within HRM.

70%-100%: The learner will be able to demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes and be able to facilitate informed decisions when dealing with employees.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- Carbery, R. and C. Cross. *Human Resource Management: A Concise Introduction*. UK: Palgrave Macmillan, 2013.

- Gunnigle, P., N. Heraty and M. Morley. *Human Resource Management: Theory and Practice in Ireland*. 3rd ed. Dublin: Gill & MacMillan, 2011.

Supplementary Material

- "People management magazine ." <http://www.cipd.co.uk>
- Marchington, M. and A. Wilkinson. *Human Resource Management at Work*. 4th ed. UK: CIPD, 2012.
- Torrington, D., L. Hall, S. Taylor and C. Atkinson. *Human Resource Management*. 9th ed. UK: Pearson, 2014.
- Truss, C., D. Mankin and C. Kelliher. *Strategic Human Resource Management*. UK: Oxford, 2012.